

Marco Uderzo

PhD Student @ IGFL - Data Scientist, MSc

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Profile

PhD Student in Computational Neurobiology @ IGFL - ENS de Lyon, in the "Spatio-Temporal Logic of Adult Neurogenesis" team. My research combines machine learning, spatial transcriptomics, and single-cell omics to study the spatial molecular landscapes of the two neurogenic niches of the adult mouse brain, aiming to identify both shared and distinct molecular mechanisms of adult neurogenesis. I earned a Master's Degree in Data Science from the University of Padova.

Areas of Expertise

Machine Learning - Deep Learning - Computational Biology - Bioinformatics - Molecular Biology - Computer Vision

Professional Experience

PhD Student (*Institute of Functional Genomics, IGFL - ENS de Lyon*) **Lyon, France** 09/2025 - Present

PhD Student in Computational Neurobiology, in the "Spatio-Temporal Logic of Adult Neurogenesis" team.

Bioinformatics Engineer (*Institute of Functional Genomics, IGFL - ENS de Lyon*) **Lyon, France** 01/2025 - 08/2025

Bioinformatics Engineer IE in the "Spatio-Temporal Logic of Adult Neurogenesis" team and Equipex+ "Spatial-Cell-ID" facility.

- Spatial transcriptomics and deep learning applied to the study of adult neurogenesis in the mouse brain.
- Analysis and integration of high-resolution Visium HD datasets using Scanpy, Squidpy, and SpatialData.
- Implementation of spatial cell-type deconvolution pipelines, deep learning pipelines for cell segmentation custom binning and feature extraction using Cell2Location, Stardist and Bin2Cell.
- Comparative analysis of neurogenic regions to identify shared molecular mechanisms.

Research Intern (*Institute of Functional Genomics, IGFL - ENS de Lyon*) **Lyon, France** 10/2024 - 12/2024

- Spatial transcriptomics and deep learning applied to the study of adult neurogenesis in the mouse brain.

Student Trainee (*Dept. of Biomedical Sciences, University of Padua*) **Padua, Italy** 07/2024 - 08/2024

- After visiting Prof. Pennuto's Lab (Dept. of Biomedical Sciences) and shadowing two PhD students in September 2023, I decided to pursue an extracurricular wet-lab traineeship to learn and practice basic molecular biology and biochemistry techniques.
- Matured a deeper understanding of the origins of omics data in a wet lab, complementing my dry lab computational knowledge.
- Familiarized with wet lab protocols, experiment design, hypothesis formulation and testing.

Software Engineering Intern (*Airlapp S.R.L.S.*) **Piove di Sacco, Padua, Italy** 07/2022 - 09/2022

- Analysis, Design and C# Implementation of Meta Avatars SDK in a R&D context, Metaverse-Oriented Virtual Reality prototyping on Oculus Quest platform.
- Learned Unity Netcode, Photon Engine, Photon Realtime, OculusVR Platform technologies and infrastructures. Gained transversal skills and knowledge about development and use of 3D-Based Softwares.

Education

Master's Degree, Data Science *University of Padua* **Padua (PD), Italy**

- Thesis: "Leveraging Spatial Transcriptomics and Machine Learning to Study Adult Neurogenesis Dynamics in the Mouse Brain"
- Relevant Courses: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, Introduction to Molecular Biology, Biological Data, Omics in Human Disease, Structural Bioinformatics, Fundamental and Applied Genomics, Computational Genomics, Statistical Learning, Mathematical Optimization.

Erasmus, Biologie Moléculaire et Cellulaire *Université Claude Bernard Lyon 1* **Lyon, France**

MSc Erasmus semester focused on the study of Fundamental, Applied and Computational Genomics.

Bachelor's Degree, Computer Science *University of Padua* **Padua (PD), Italy**

- Thesis: "Meta Avatars SDK: study, analysis and development for Virtual Reality"
- Contributed to an Academic Research Project under the supervision of Prof. Mauro Conti. Automation of the Retrieval, Parsing and Validation Processes of a large dataset for training of an LSTM Artificial Neural Network.

High School Diploma, Liceo Classico *Liceo Ginnasio G.B. Brocchi* **Bassano del Grappa (VI), Italy**

Main Projects

Leveraging Spatial Transcriptomics & Machine Learning to Study Adult Neurogenesis in the Mouse Brain

MSc Research Internship and Thesis carried out at IGFL (Lyon), in the "Spatio-Temporal Logic of Adult Neurogenesis" team (Supervisors: Dr. Zayna Chaker, Dr. Sergio Sarnataro). Data analysis of Visium and high-resolution Visium HD Spatial Transcriptomics datasets to investigate Adult Neurogenesis dynamics in the mouse brain. Integration of Scanpy, Squidpy and SpatialData for preprocessing, visualization and spatial gene expression analysis. Implementation of the Cell2Location pipeline for spatial cell-type deconvolution of multiple Visium datasets of the mouse olfactory bulb. Cell segmentation and custom binning of multiple high-resolution Visium HD datasets of the V-SVZ and DG of the mouse brain using the Bin2Cell pipeline and Stardist, and data analysis of the processed datasets for the identification of shared molecular mechanisms across neurogenic niches.

Modelling and Functional Characterization of a Protein Domain Family [GitHub Repository](#)

Construction of Sequence Model, assessment of Taxonomic Lineage, Gene Ontology annotations assessment for Functional Enrichment, and identifications of conserved Short Linear Motifs within the Pyridoxamine Kinase/Phosphomethylpyrimidine Kinase Domain Family.

Classification of Contacts in Protein Structures with Deep Learning [GitHub Repository](#)

Classification of Residue-Residue Interactions in Protein Structures using Feed Forward Deep Neural Networks. Developed in Python using BioPython and Keras.

Zeroth-Order Frank-Wolfe Optimization for Black-Box Adversarial Attacks [GitHub Repository](#)

Implementation of Faster Zeroth-Order Conditional Gradient Sliding (Gao et al.) and Stochastic Gradient-Free Frank-Wolfe (Sahu et al.) applied to Adversarial Attacks against MNIST Recognition Deep Neural Network.

Tools

- **Python Libraries and Frameworks:** Scanpy, Squidpy, SpatialData, Tensorflow, Keras, PyTorch, Scikit-learn, OpenCV, BioPython, Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, Seaborn
- **Programming Languages:** Python, R, Bash, SQL, C, C++
- **Other:** LaTeX, Git

Certifications

- B2 FCE English Certification (Graded 186, C1 Level) (Apr. 2017) - [Cambridge University Press & Assessment English](#)
- B1 French Certification (Jun. 2023) - [University of Padua](#)

Languages

- **Italian** [Native]
- **French** [A2/B1] - Learning
- **English** [C1]